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Death Sentence to Brigadier 'Shaitan Singh'

The terrorist organizations started carefully monitoring my movements. They noticed that I used to visit the Division HQ frequently, to brief the GOC, Major General Inder Varma. Accordingly, they worked out a meticulous plan to get rid of me in an urban ambush in the heart of Baramulla town at Tashkent Chowk. It was something like the ambush of the Sri Lankan cricket team in Lahore some years ago. I often wonder how we escaped death that day.

As I recall the events on that clear summer day in 1992, based on my memory of the interrogation of captured terrorists, information from local sources, and a vivid description given by an officer who happened to be on leave and present in Baramulla that day, I have reconstructed the deadly ambush.

Terrorists' Hideout – Baramulla, July 1992

'This b——d of a brigadier, "Shaitan Singh," is becoming a pain. We have to get rid of him', said the leader in a deep voice.

'Tomorrow, I understand he is likely to drive through Baramulla. Though the son of a bitch never follows a predictable routine, my "source" is very sure of his information this time. We shall give this infidel such a reception that he and his protection team wouldn't know what hit them. None of these motherf——s of the "Shaitan" Brigade should get away alive.' He then unfolded his plan to his handpicked comrades in a cool and deliberate manner, leaving no room for error.

'Have you understood? Koi shak *(any doubts)', he asked. The others just nodded.*

'Okay then get on with it, and Insha Allah, we shall be crowned with success. I must caution you – never underestimate these kafirs and their commander. I know this